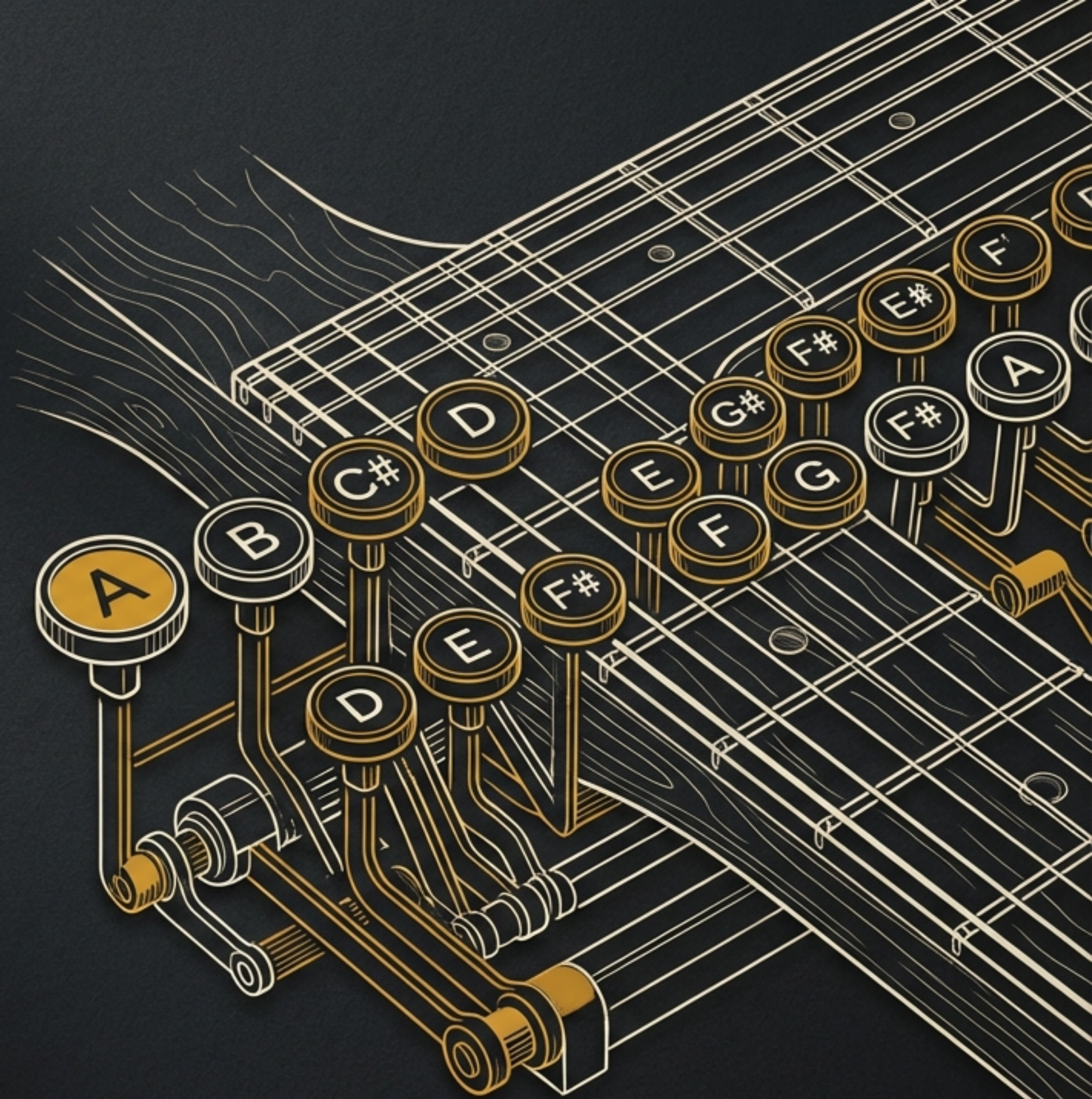


LESSON 4: MECHANICS OF HARMONY

The Logic of Chords

Unlocking the Fretboard

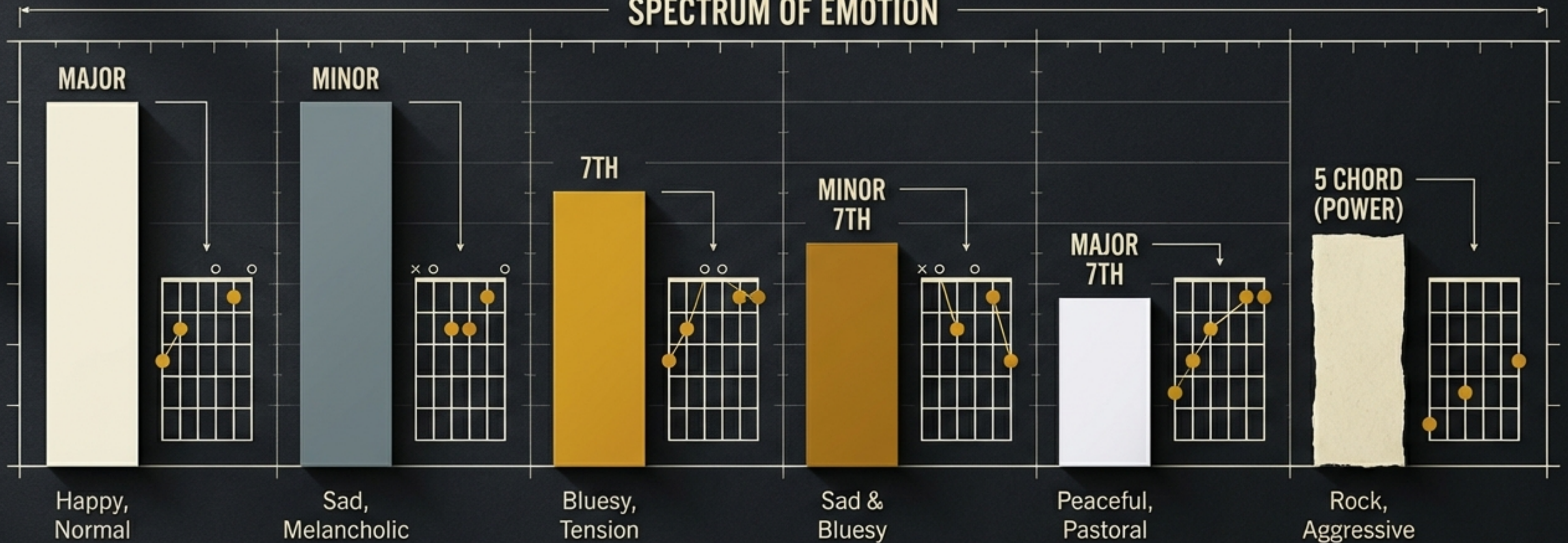
Absolutely Understand Guitar



CHORDS ARE TOOLS OF EMOTION

A chord is a selection of notes played simultaneously to evoke a specific mood. While there are approximately 45 chord types, popular music relies on a core set to drive emotional narrative.

SPECTRUM OF EMOTION



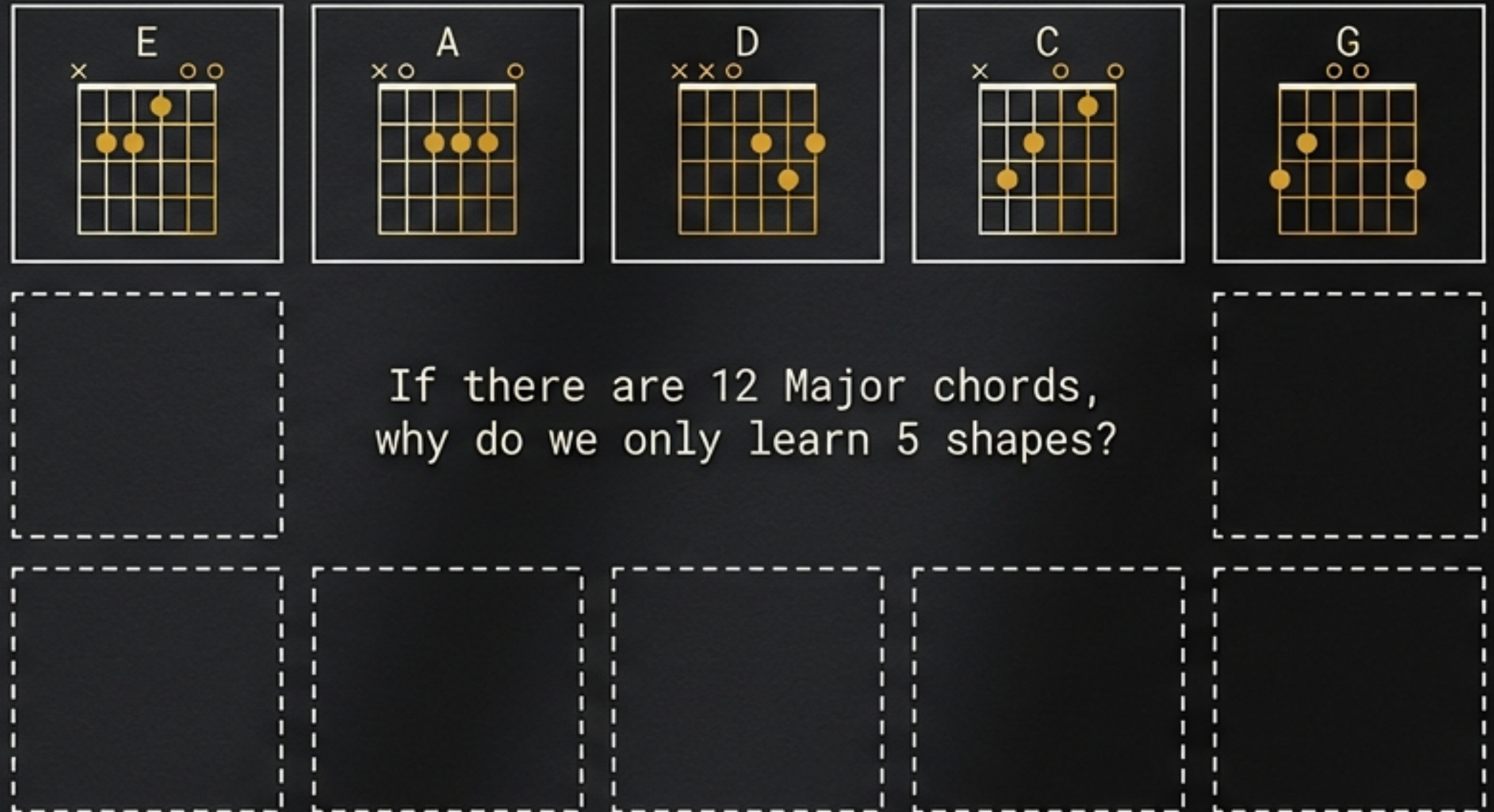
THE MATHEMATICAL PARADOX

THE THEORY

THE RULE OF 12

- 12 Notes in the Alphabet
- 12 Possible Keys
- 12 Variations of every chord

THE REALITY

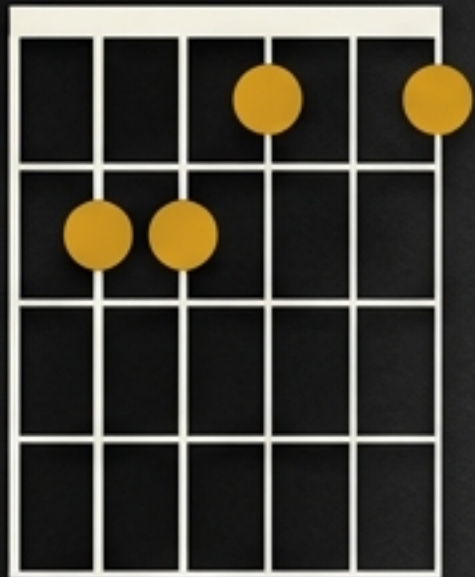


“Is the guitar **incomplete**? Or is there a **deeper logic**?”

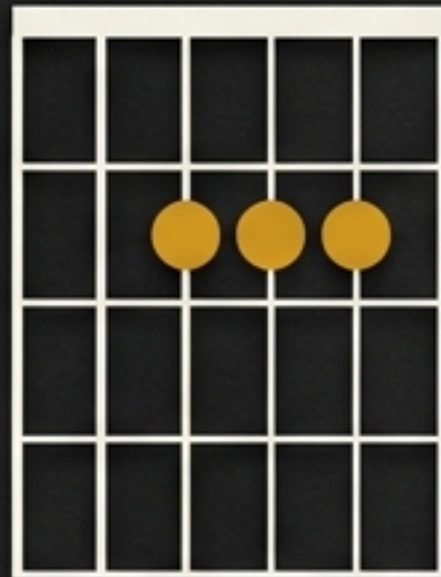
THE PHYSICAL LIMITATION

There are only 5 possible finger forms.

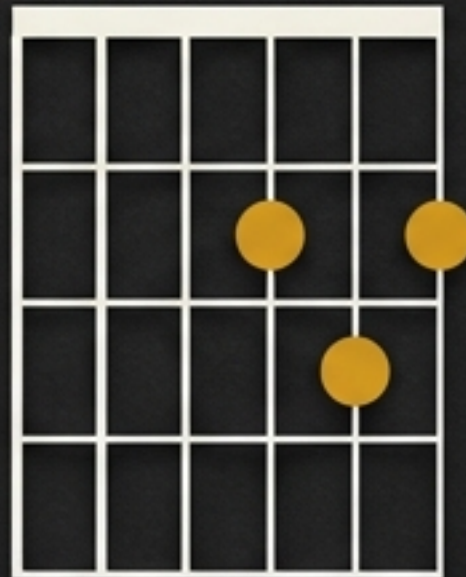
E FORM



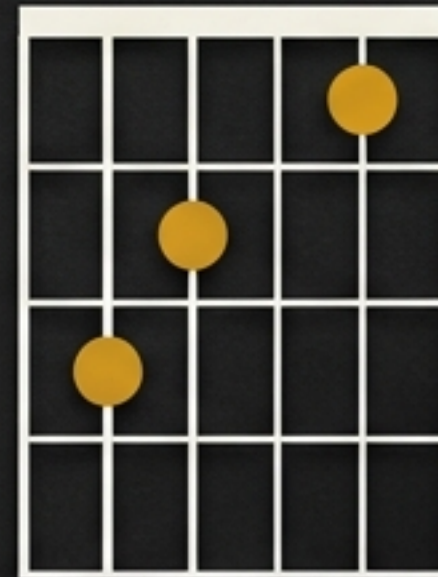
A FORM



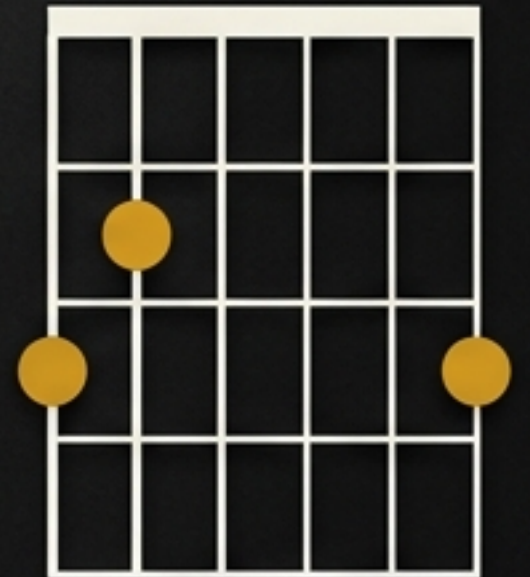
D FORM



C FORM

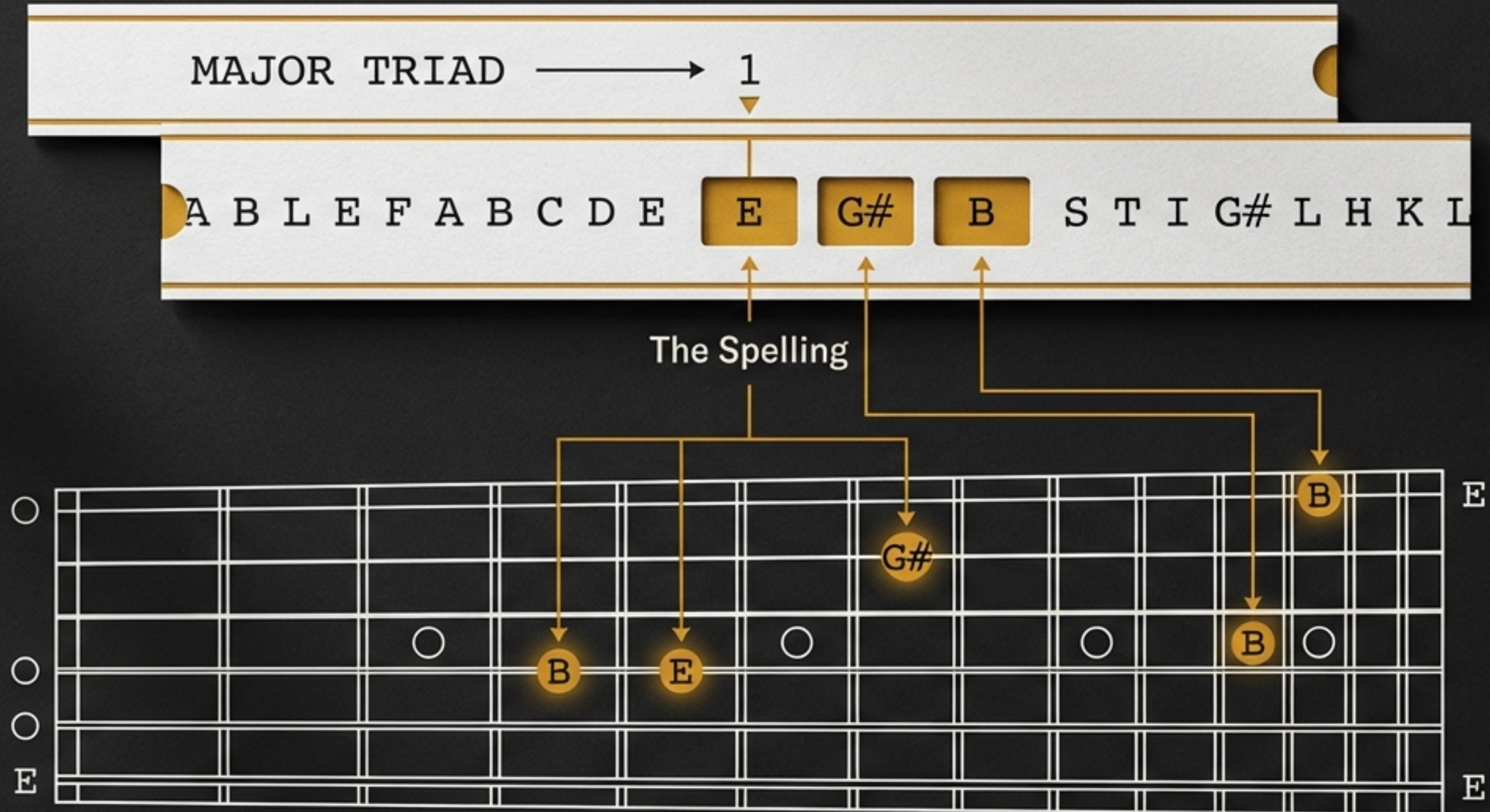


G FORM



Owing to the physical biomechanics of the human hand, you cannot physically finger every mathematical combination. We do not learn 12 unique sharpnes; we learn these **5 Forms** and move them.

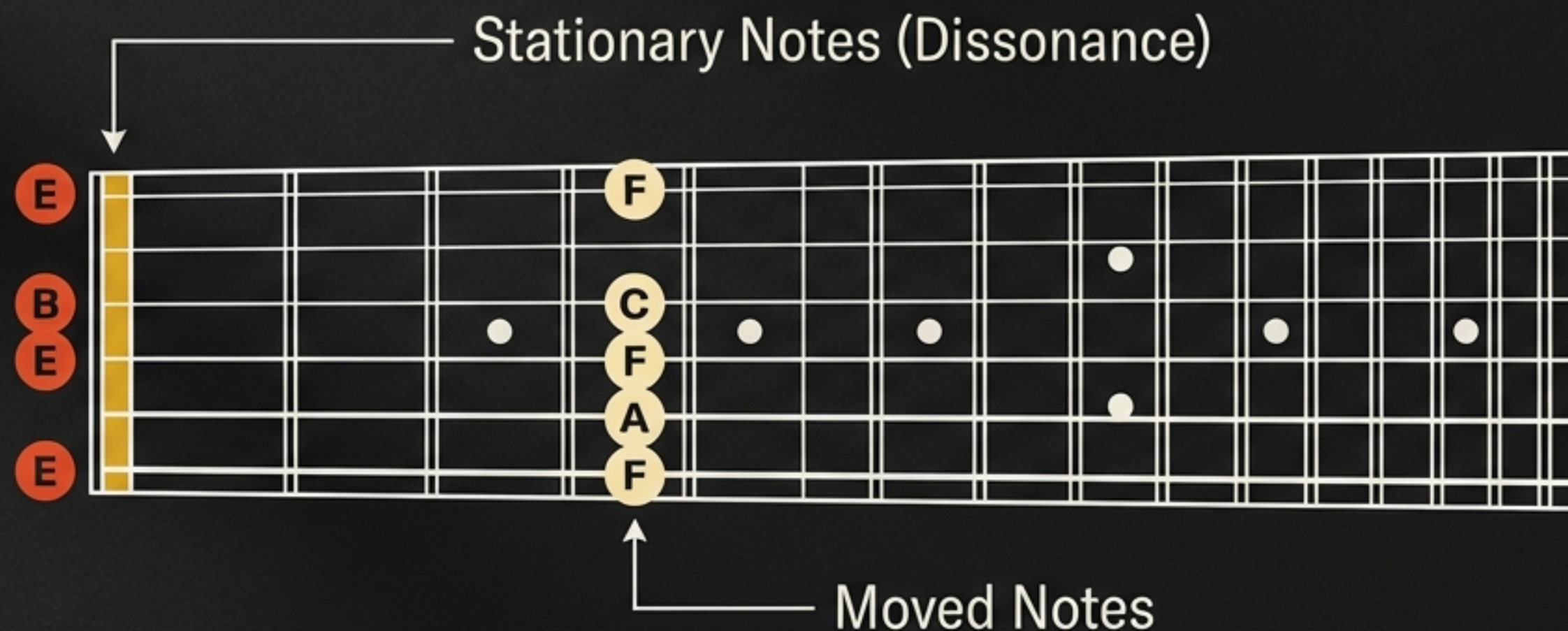
THE GUITAR IS A TYPEWRITER



Just as a typewriter keys specific letters to form words, the guitar 'types' the notes E, G#, and B to form the E Major Chord.

THE OPEN STRING FALLACY

Beginners often view open strings as non-events. But open strings are part of the chord's spelling. If you move the fingers but not the open strings, the spelling breaks.



Result: A chaotic mix of F Major and E Major.

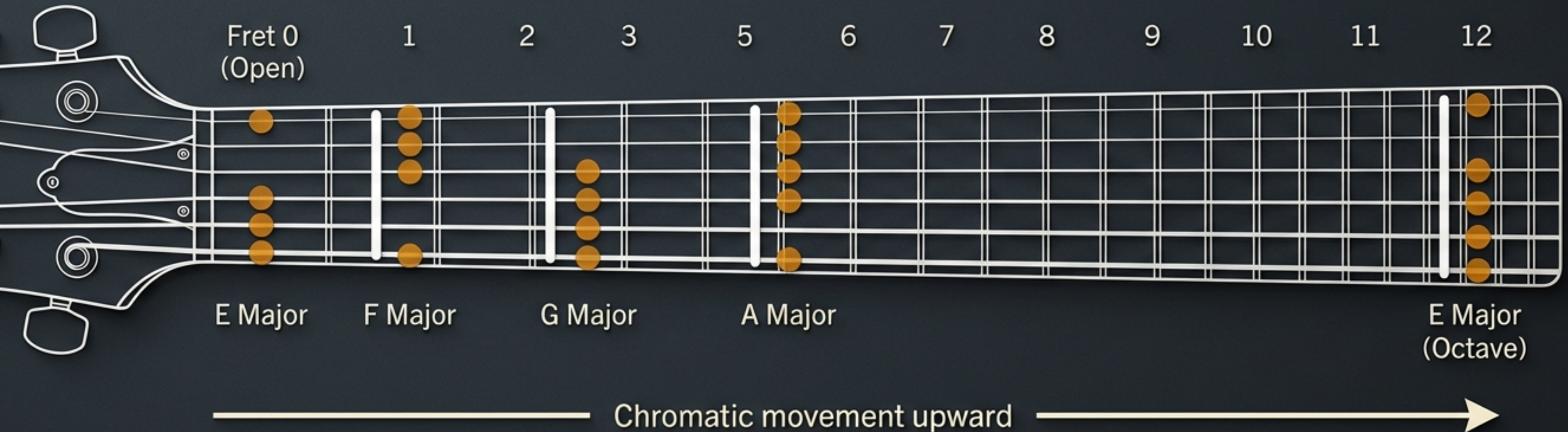
THE MOVABLE NUT

The Mechanics of the Bar Chord



To fix the dissonance, the index finger acts as a clamp, raising the pitch of the open strings to match the fretted notes. The entire instrument effectively shortens.

ONE SHAPE, TWELVE KEYS

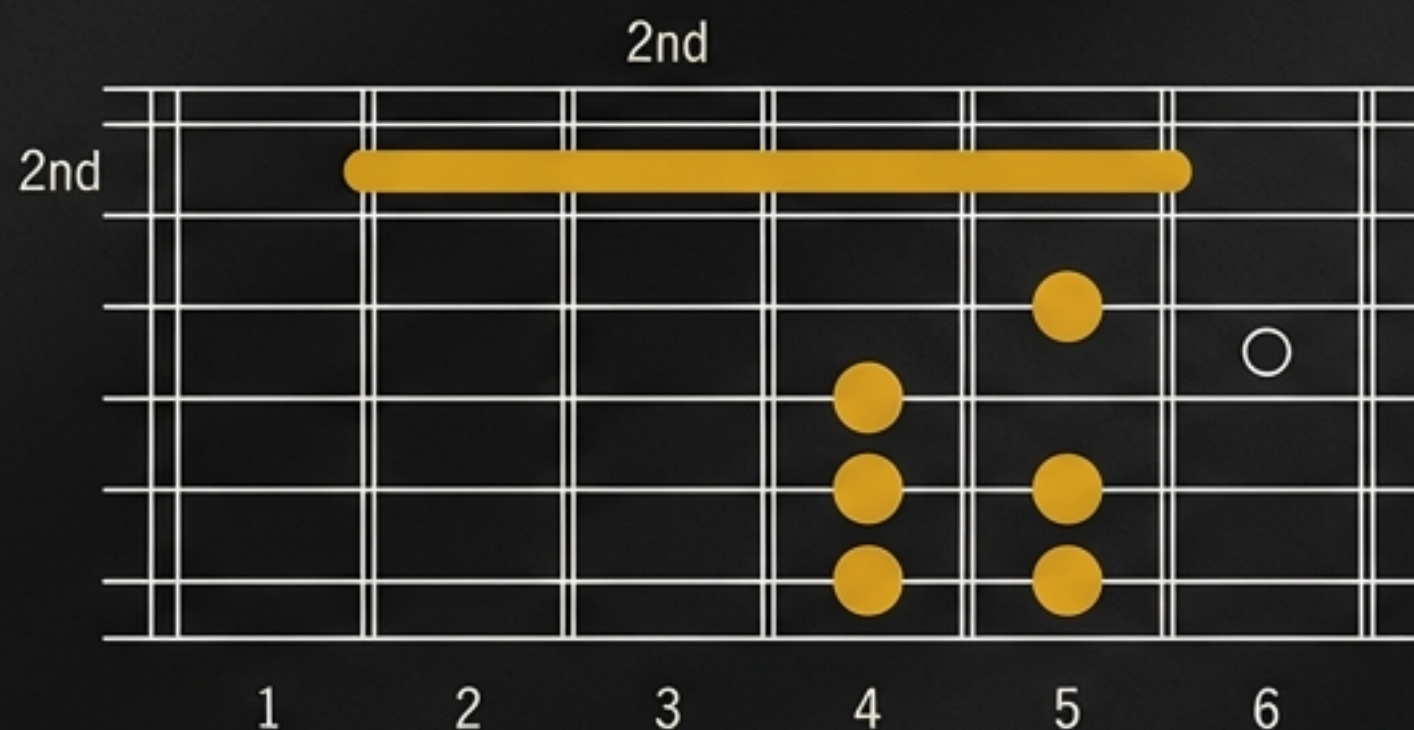


By mastering the Bar technique, the simple E Form becomes a universal key to the entire fretboard.

THE UNIVERSAL SYSTEM

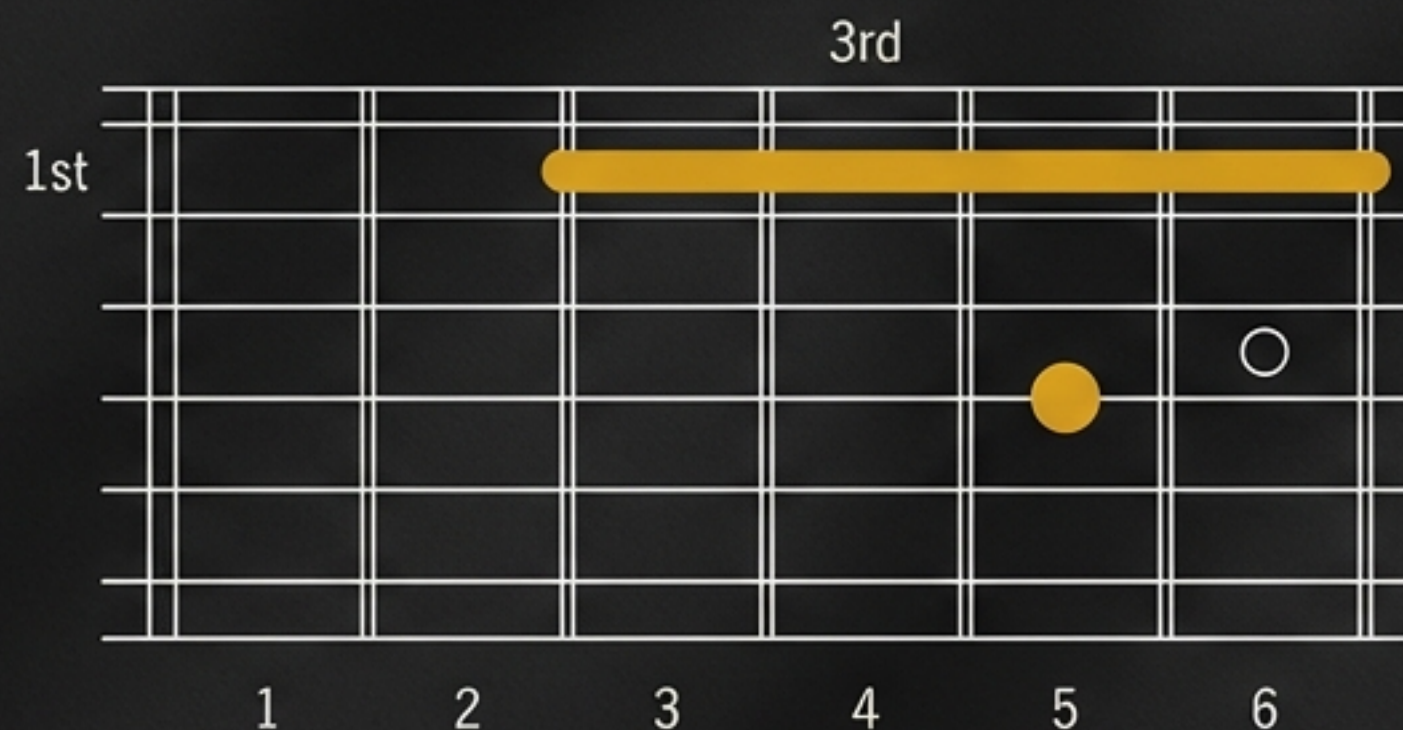
The logic of the Movable Nut applies to all 5 Forms. While C and G forms are physically demanding to bar, the A and D forms are essential tools for rock and pop.

THE A FORM BAR CHORD



B MAJOR (A FORM)

THE D FORM BAR CHORD

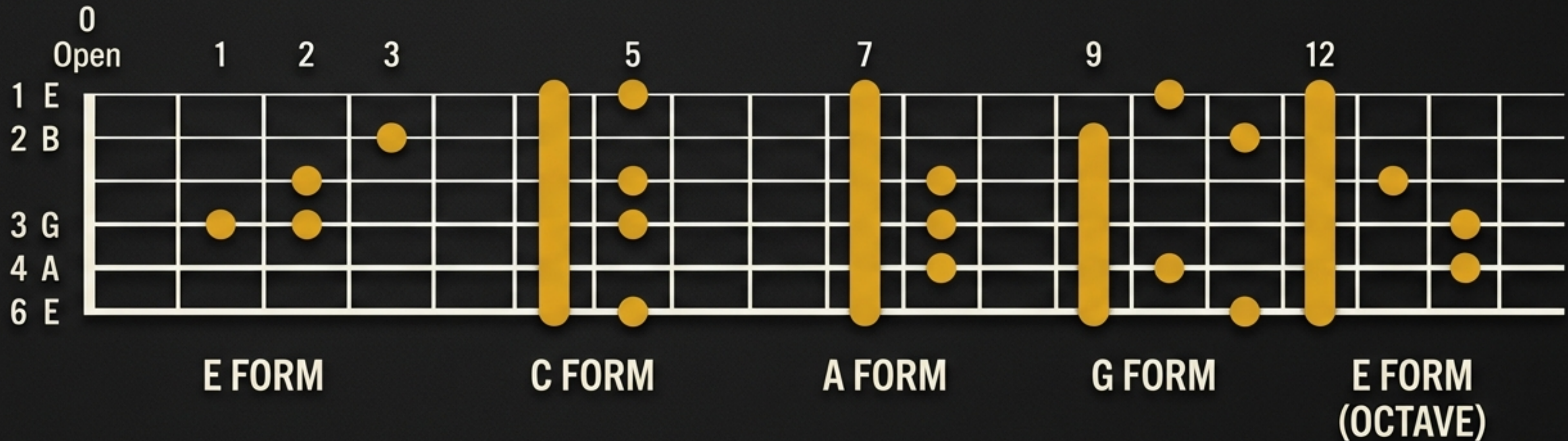


F MAJOR (D FORM)

Any shape can be moved if the open strings are accounted for.

FIVE WAYS TO PLAY ONE CHORD

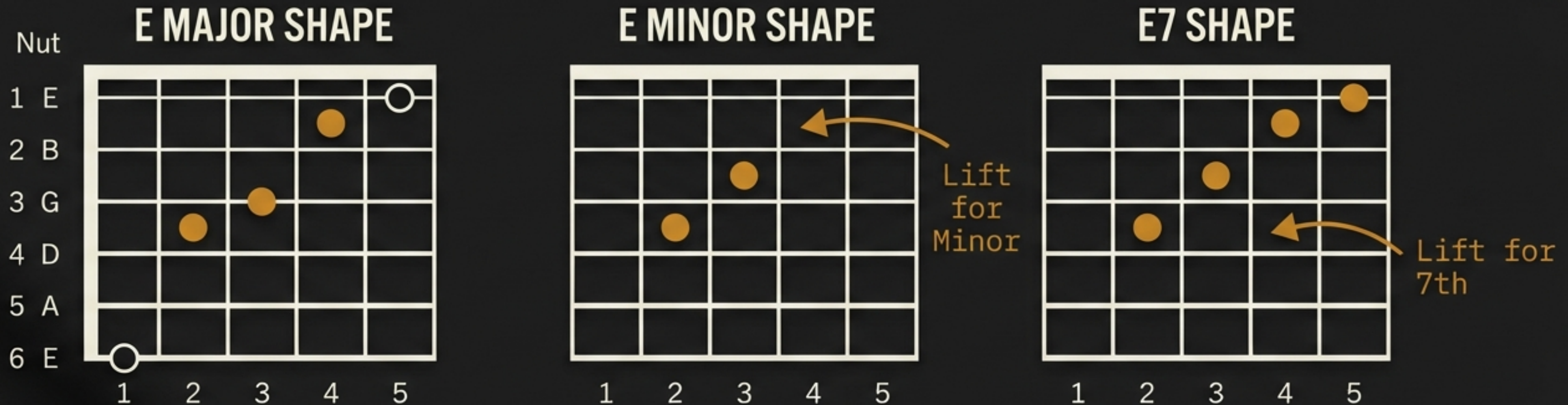
Inverting the Logic



Just as one shape can play 12 keys, one specific chord (e.g., E Major) can be played in 5 different positions. Each has a unique “voicing” based on octave and note order.

BEYOND MAJOR: THE VARIATIONS

The 5 Form system is not limited to Major chords. It applies to Minors, 7ths, and beyond.



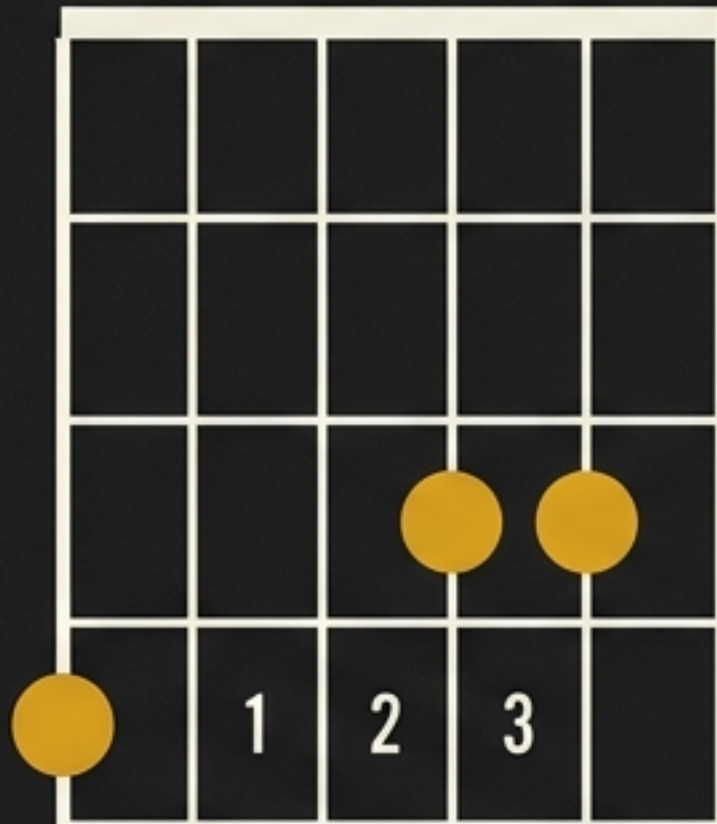
These modifications happen within the shape, meaning the entire shape—variations included—can still be barred and moved.

THE POWER CHORD (5 CHORD)

The Staple of Rock & Metal

E FORM POWER CHORD

X X X X X



A FORM POWER CHORD

X X X



TYPEWRITER NOTE:
THE TUNING WARP

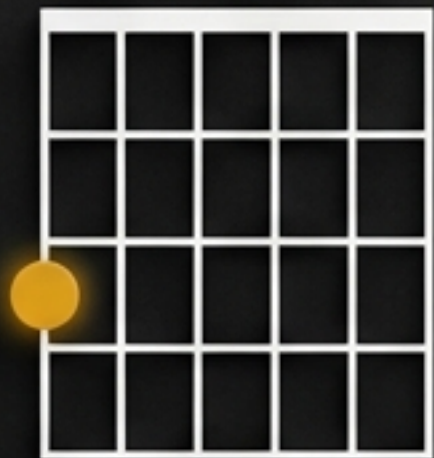
When moving shapes across strings, remember the interval between the G and B string changes.

Any pattern moving onto the B string must be raised one fret.

THE FOUNDATION: ROOT NOTES

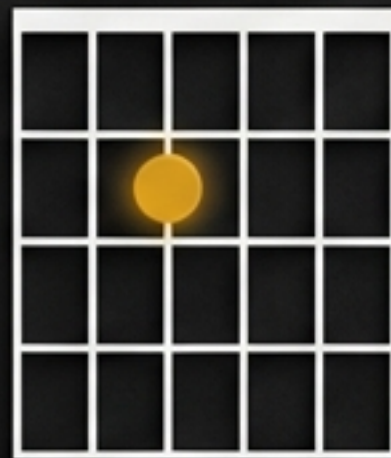
The Root Note is the nucleus of the chord. It determines the chord's name. As a rule, do not play strings lower in pitch than the root.

E FORM



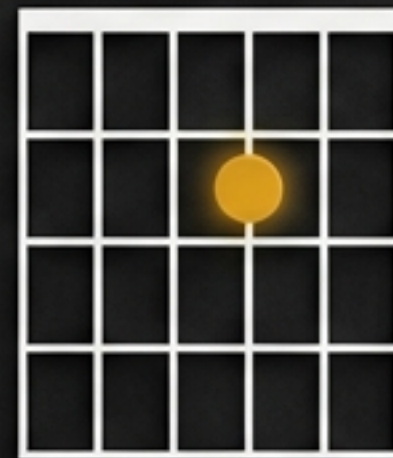
**Root
Location**

A FORM



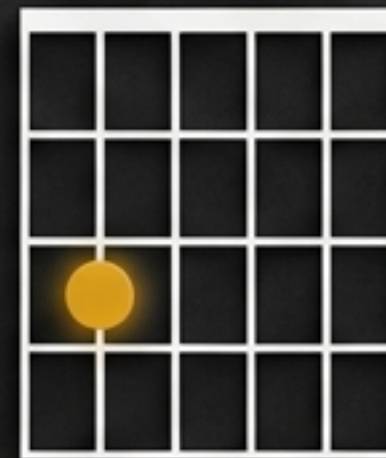
**Root
Location**

D FORM



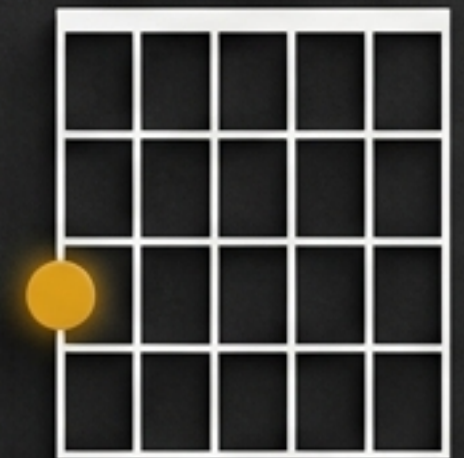
**Root
Location**

C FORM



**Root
Location**

G FORM



**Root
Location**

SUMMARY OF THE SYSTEM

12 Notes exist, but only 5 Physical Forms (CAGED).



The Bar acts as a Movable Nut, allowing forms to slide.



The Root Note determines the name (Key) of the chord.

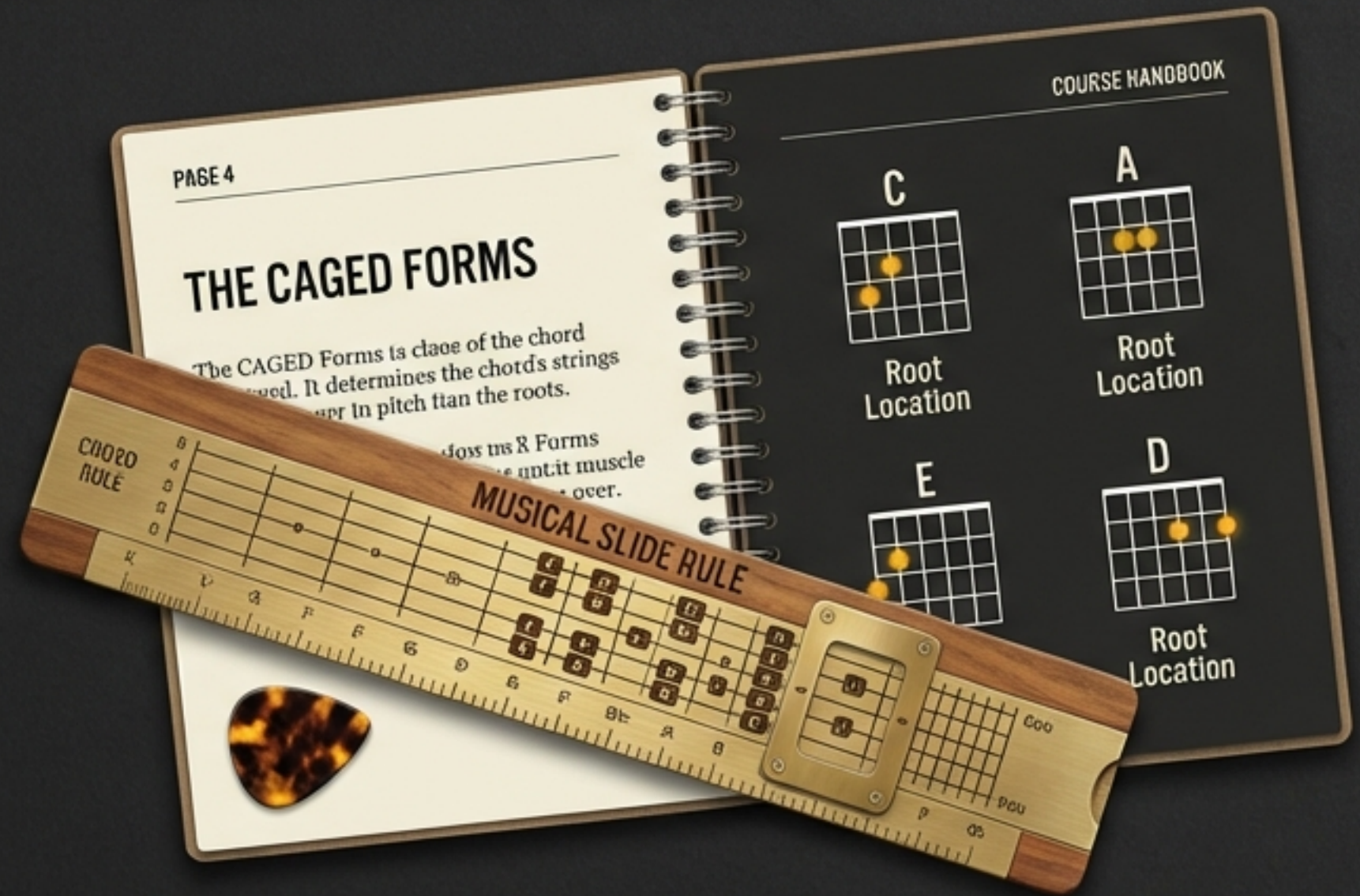


Therefore: Every chord can be played in 5 positions.

Mastery Goal: Instant recall ('Get there like **that**'). Timeline: 2-3 Years.

MASTER THE VOCABULARY

1. Review the charts in the Handbook.
2. Practice the 5 Forms until muscle memory takes over.
3. Memorise the Root Notes on the E and A strings.



“You don’t learn 12 shapes.
You learn 5 shapes and move them.”